A Brilliant $2,000,000/Month Shopify Niche Store

Channel: Arie Scherson · Published: Oct 22, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BPB3QRFV1bU Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

A print-on-demand dog-niche store (I Heart Dogs) earns an estimated $2M/month by combining low-cost impulse products, a cause-driven subscription upsell, and 720 simultaneous Meta image ads.

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🐶 The Brand: I Heart Dogs Overview 0:21

- The brand operates on a **print-on-demand dropshipping** model — one of the older e-commerce models, but still effective
  - Arie notes that some tactics from 2019 still work today, while things that worked last year may no longer work
- The brand sells dog-themed merchandise (apparel, accessories, tote bags, etc.) and has layered in a modern subscription component
- They also sell dog food and a wide variety of other dog-related products
  - Example new product: "Rain Doodle Premium Sweatshirt" targeting the currently trending Goldendoodle dog breed, timed ahead of Christmas
- The store is **not** built on Shopify — Arie considers this a disadvantage
  - His view: Shopify gives more control and has the best e-commerce infrastructure after Amazon

💰 Revenue Estimation & Traffic 1:24

- Estimated annual revenue: **$14.8M – $17.9M** (exact figures unknown without access to their dashboard)
- Monthly traffic: approximately **500,000 visitors**
- Traffic is predominantly from the **United States**, which Arie describes as the highest-quality e-commerce traffic in the world
- Based on the US-heavy traffic volume and his own experience, Arie confidently estimates **~$2M/month in revenue**

🛒 The Sales Funnel Breakdown 1:45

- Entry product: a **$3 tote bag** — a very low-cost impulse item designed to get people into the funnel
- **Step 1 — Add to Cart:** clicking "Add to Cart" takes the user to the cart page

- **Step 2 — First Upsell (cart page):** a banner offering the "Hero VIP Club" subscription for **$5/month**
  - The subscription promise: feeds **5 shelter dogs per month**
  - Cause-driven framing makes it emotionally compelling for dog lovers
- **Step 3 — Full Subscription Landing Page (post-cart, pre-checkout):** a dedicated full page pushing the subscription harder
  - This step happens *after* the cart page — Arie notes this placement is rare on Shopify/e-commerce stores
  - Tiered subscription options presented:

Tier	Price	Benefit
Basic	$5.00/month	Feeds 5 shelter dogs
Mid	$9.99/month	Feeds more dogs
Premium	$24.99/month	Feeds even more dogs

- The landing page includes social proof and persuasive copy to convert dog-loving visitors

- **Step 4 — Checkout:** shipping is charged (not free)
- After signing up, users are directed to a **Typeform** — Arie speculates this connects to an internal system that actually tracks/delivers dog food aid
  - He believes the charity element is genuine, citing their longevity as evidence

> The genius of the funnel is turning a $3 impulse purchase into a recurring subscription by attaching it to a cause (feeding shelter dogs) — transforming one-time buyers into monthly recurring revenue.

📢 Meta Ads Strategy 3:31

- Currently running **720 active ads simultaneously** on Meta
- Ad creative strategy: keep it **simple but high volume**
  - The majority of their best-performing ads are **image ads** (static images), not video
  - Image ads are easier and cheaper to produce — a major advantage for new entrants
- Ad creative formats observed:
  - **Meme-style ads:** e.g., "When you buy this, you're giving them their Christmas dinner" — not a pure meme but uses meme formatting
  - **Emotional/direct-response copy ads:** example copy — *"I waited, but no one came. I cried, but no one listened. My time is running out, but there is one last hope. Will you sign me up?"* — Arie calls this "brilliant direct response marketing"
  - **Native-style ads:** look like organic content rather than advertisements; designed to stop the scroll because they don't look like ads
  - **Trend-jacking ads:** e.g., using Dolly Parton imagery (Arie questions legality of this use)
- Key ad insight: **ads that don't look like ads perform best** in the current environment
- Arie suggests competitors/newcomers can:
  - Copy the ad formats and paste them into **ChatGPT** to recreate similar ads for their own brand
  - Continuously test new products within the same niche using Meta ads

🔑 Key Success Factors 7:03

- **Subscription model:** adds predictable recurring revenue on top of one-off product sales; the VIP Club upsell converts transactional buyers into long-term subscribers
- **Constant ad testing:** running hundreds of ads simultaneously to find winners; volume of testing is itself a competitive moat
- **Trend adaptation:** rapidly launching new products tied to current trends (e.g., Goldendoodle sweatshirt ahead of Christmas)
  - Print-on-demand makes this effortless — new designs can be created with AI (ChatGPT) and added to the store instantly with no inventory risk
- **Clear brand mission:** saving dogs and helping people express love for their dogs — this emotional alignment drives both conversions and subscriber retention
- **Simple, effective landing pages:** clean pages with good reviews; nothing over-engineered
- **Cause-driven storytelling in ads:** showcasing rescue stories and impact creates emotional connection and trust
- **Longevity signal:** the brand has been operating for years, suggesting the model is genuinely sustainable

🛠️ Tools & Resources Mentioned 4:55

- **Team Drop** (akemi.co/sourcing) — sourcing and shipping platform
  - Handles all inventory management
  - No upfront inventory purchase required for most products
  - Has a dedicated **print-on-demand section** ideal for replicating this model
  - China-based with relatively fast international shipping; supports selling to multiple global markets
  - **100% free** to use
  - Arie used it to scale his own brand
- **Shopify** (akemi.co/shopify) — recommended e-commerce platform
  - Currently: free to start, then **$1/month for 3 months**
  - Includes **$10,000 in Shopify credits**
  - Shopify Plus signup includes **$15,000 in credits** (Arie personally used this when doing ~$300K–$400K/month)
- **ChatGPT / AI** — for generating print-on-demand designs and rewriting ad copy
- **Akemi.co** — Arie's agency/consulting firm (Meta's top-tier agency partner)
  - Consulting link available for brand owners needing direct help (limited availability — Arie notes he has time for roughly 1-hour calls)
- **Alchemy.co** — Arie's previous agency managing large Meta ad budgets
- Arie's own Shopify brand: currently doing **$600K/month**, targeting **$1M/month** by year-end